

Ἰωάννης ὁ Μαλάλας Ἀντιοχεύς

John Malalas of Antioch and the Universal Chronicle

eul_aid: vae

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

John Malalas of Antioch was a 6th-century CE Greek chronicler. His name likely derives from the Syriac word for "rhetor." He is identified as a *grammatikos* and possibly served as a high-ranking civil servant in Antioch. He lived primarily in that city, though he may have moved later to Constantinople. His work demonstrates knowledge of events extending into the 560s CE during the reign of Emperor Justinian I.

His only surviving work is the **Chronographia**, an 18-book world chronicle spanning from the Biblical creation to approximately 563 or 564 CE. Written in vernacular Koine Greek, it is a foundational text for late antique historiography and popular culture. The chronicle preserves crucial local Antiochene traditions and provides a vital contemporary narrative for the reign of Justinian. It was extremely influential, serving as a major source for later Byzantine chroniclers and being translated into Old Church Slavonic and Georgian.

Works (3)

- [Χρονολογικόν](#) · [Chronicle](#) · 18 passages
- [Χρονογραφία](#) · [Chronography](#) · 474 passages
- [Χρονογραφία](#) · [Chronography, Selections](#) · 12 passages